Trying To Tell You Something That I've Already Said

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Trying To Tell You Something That I've Already Said

by realmzer39

Summary

Catra took in a shaky breath, eyes avoiding the deer knee. “You couldn’t have done this earlier?” she asked, voice gagging.

“I could’ve, but we’re doing it now,” Adora said. “Now, come on, pull out its guts.”

Catra gave a disgusted expression toward Adora, then aiming the expression at the deer knee before quickly turning away from it. “Yeah, no, I am not doing that.”

Notes

has this been done before?

See the end of the work for more notes

Over one week. That was how long the team had been stranded out in the wilderness. Well, 'stranded' hadn't been the precise term to use ever since they'd found the cabin, though that was only primarily used as shelter. Still, 'stranded' hadn't felt like the correct definition to use for their circumstances anymore, at least not to Adora. 'Stuck', maybe, or 'waiting' or sometimes even maybe 'trapped' had felt more appropriate -'stuck' did seem to roll off the tongue a little better, so she decided to go with that. The timeframe of it all was the only thing that couldn't be changed.

Some, mainly Entrapta, had decided to keep up with the number of hours and minutes that they'd been stuck: two hundred forty hours, fifteen minutes, and thirty seven seconds. The number kept going up each time someone had asked for exactly how long it'd been since the plane crash specifically, her tone somehow so chipper and excited to answer despite the reactions from the rest. A part of Adora felt that the chipperness and excitement was necessary, a break from the stress and dread that they'd all surrounded themselves with more during the light hours than they would at night. A different part didn't understand why Entrapta felt that announcing those hundreds of hours, those precise minutes, the exact seconds in such a joyful tone was right. Why she didn't understand that no one else held whatever excitement she felt about their situation, whatever positive outlook not many of the others related to.

Bow tried to relate to it at times, Scorpia did her best to copy Entrapta's energy, while everyone else simply smiled tightly and went along with whatever she tried to say. Adora couldn't help but feel a little mean thinking about it all that way, especially when Entrapta had been the main person among the team who had the most knowledge of what to do in order to survive. She'd been the first person to tend to everyone's wounds, the first person to start opening the exit door of the plane, the first person to start fixing up what she could of the cabin. Based on her confidence, Adora was certain that Entrapta could have rebuilt the whole cabin if she so pleased.

Adora couldn't truly say she could do much of the same. She was the second person to help get everyone out of the plane, the second person to tend to people's wounds, the last person to wake up while the plane had been going down, and the first girl to fall on her menstrual cycle. It didn't help much that everyone else had followed suit shortyly after, some even surprised that it'd arrived at all due to all the stress. For a reason she wasn't sure she could explain, Adora was glad that almost all of the girls were able to go through their time of the month. Maybe because they all felt more connected because of it, or maybe because it meant they were surviving in some form or another. Whatever the case, it was nice to be able to spot a silver lining in the most irritable of things.

Presently, however, the team had been focusing on more than just the blood killing them from the inside. Since it'd been more than a week, they'd all run out of supplies and clean clothes, and the dust inside the cabin never seemed to go away, making a few people sneeze and cough more than usual, the day was set out to do as many chores as they could. From laundry, to meals, to dusting, to hunting, to gathering water, to chopping some fire wood all in order to last another week before they did it all again. That wasn't too much of a bad idea, Adora made a note to make sure to suggest it to the rest of the team once the day was done.

"Hey, breakfast is on the right," Glimmer called before Bow dipped his bowl in a pot not filled with breakfast.

He grumbled to himself before shuddering at the thought of what could have been. "Not that I have a problem with all of this but couldn't you have done breakfast first then - *this*?" Bow asked.

"Sure, if you want us all to just bleed out," Glimmer said, her tone more passive than it would have normally been as she placed red towels over a small rack to let them dry.

"Nevermind, you do you," Bow said with a tight smile before walking away to sit at the steps of the cabin to eat his breakfast.

Adora chuckled to herself at the interaction, chopping off more pieces of bark for firewood. "Doing ok there, Bow?" she asked.

"Never been better," he said as joyfully as he could with another thumbs up.

Adora let out a laugh, raising the axe to cut another piece of wood, until her focus was cut off by a loud '*clank*' in the distance. Everyone's focus seemed to have been cut off, as they all looked over to where the noise came from, only to see Catra struggle with carrying a now full pale of water. She muttered curses to herself, setting the pale down, shaking off her hands which what Adora could best assume probably had deep indents on them. Everyone watched as Catra tried to drag the pale the rest of the way to the cabin, splashes of water dropping on the ground. It took four seconds before she set it down, seemingly decided she'd been close enough to where she was asked to have left it. She took a few panting breaths, stretching out her hands and back, staring at the pale with a sense of anger and frustration Adora hadn't rarely seen if this one hadn't felt so different.

"Oh wow, she came back with something," Glimmer said, a smirk growing on her face.

Adora put down the axe and walked over toward Catra, noticing the sweat dripping down her forehead. "Here, let me help," Adora said, reaching down to grab the pale.

Catra picked the pale back up, only letting Adora brush a finger over it. "I got it," she said, firm before taking five steps before setting the pale down once more, but not without more splashes of water jumping out. "Goddammit," she muttered to herself, walking over to one of the chairs and dropping herself onto it, taking a long, deep breath.

The sounds of snickers came from a few feet away, Perfuma whispering something to Glimmer as they both stared at Catra, laughing. Adora stared back at them, shaking her head but not shaking away the smirks from their faces. She walked over to the

chairs and knelt down next to Catra, rubbing a hand over her shoulder. “It’s ok, Catra, you got something, that’s what matters,” she assured.

Catra pushed Adora’s hand of her shoulder, eyes still on the pale that now sat right next to Glimmer. “You jinxed me,” was all she said.

Adora tilted her head. “What?”

Catra pulled out a red stained towel from her pocket. Adora smiled a bit at the sight, still not knowing why. “You didn’t skip.” she said.

“I wish I did,” Catra said, eyes now on the towel. “I didn’t ask to be part of club flo.”

“I’d rather not have anything to worry about,” Adora said with a laugh, as Catra put the towel back in her pocket. “Make sure you put it with the others later, ok?”

Catra reached over to her backpack, taking out her pair of headphones and walkman. “Yeah sure, I’ll give it to the others,” she said with a weak smirk.

Adora raised a brow, confused by the phrasing before understanding what it was that Catra meant. “The left bucket, you know that.” she reminded, tone serious even though a part of her wanted to laugh at the thought along with Catra.

But neither of them laughed. Instead, Catra plugged the headphones into the walkman and placed them over her ears, pressing the buttons to turn it on. “Yeah, yeah, whatever,” She pressed the on button three times. She checked the volume, turning it up to its max and down to its quietest. No music seemed to play in her ears, though. She hit the device a few times on its side, taking out the plug of the headphones and blowing on the walkman five times before plugging the headphones back in. Pressed the on button again and again and again and again,

shook the device before getting frustrated and banging it on the side of the chair. “Fucking hell,” she muttered.

More snickers from the rest. Glimmer laughed once more, Perfuma did her best to contain hers, and even Bow held back his own laughter. Adora felt her teeth grit, giving herself a breath and standing back up. “Come on,” she said, taking the walkman and pulling the headphones off of Catra’s head.

“The hell?” Catra cried as Adora put the walkman in the pocket of her jacket.

“You’re coming with me, let’s go,” Adora said, grabbing Catra by the wrist and pulling her out of the chair.

The girl winced once, having Adora loosen her grip on Catra, but not stopping her from taking her behind the cabin to what the team had now turned into their meathouse. From the shape and build of it, it seemed to have always been a meathouse before the group had ever found the cabin, just cleaned and being used more than it had for however long it had been since a person had used it last. There’d been a small, skinned and cut deer hanging from the cubicle, drying from the clean Adora had given it earlier in the morning. Next to that was a table with the smaller animals that Adora and Bow had managed to hunt and skin earlier; squirrels, birds, rabbits, the odd wild turkey that Bow claimed to have scored twenty five points on. Just next to all of those had been the knee joint of the dear deer.

“Are you serious?” Catra called, realizing the reason for why Adora had dragged her there.

Adora walked the two girls over to the table, letting go of Catra’s wrist and pulling down the deer knee joint in front of them. “You’re going to help me pick out its guts,” Adora said, pulling out a knife from her pocket and putting it on the table.

Catra took in a shaky breath, eyes avoiding the deer knee. “You couldn’t have done this earlier?” she asked, voice gagging.

“I could’ve, but we’re doing it now,” Adora said. “Now, come on, pull out its guts.”

Catra gave a disgusted expression toward Adora, then aiming the expression at the deer knee before quickly turning away from it. “Yeah, no, I am not doing that.”

Adora rolled her eyes. “Fine, then I’ll start,” she said, grabbing the knife and poking it into the joint. Having been over a week it hadn’t been the first animal she’d dug into to pull the guts and bones, even having learned a few tricks to get the job done faster. And yet, each time she dug in the knife, each time she cut through something that wasn’t the animals skin, she felt herself hesitate. A ring went through her ear, a scream coming from inside her stomach that she couldn’t seem to silence no matter how hard she pushed in the knife.

“You’re not pushing hard enough,” Catra spoke.

“I’m - pushing,” Adora retorted, the ringing still in her ears, the scream going down where different kinds of screams were heard.

The knife was taken out of her hands. “You’re too scared,” Catra said, now holding the knife and moving Adora aside. “‘Til it pops, right?” she asked, not waiting for Adora to respond whether or not that was true before she dug the knife into the crevice. A sharp twist of the knife, ‘*pop*’, the joint came apart. Catra took a breath, putting down the knife and shaking away the red grease on her hands, turning away once again from the joint. “Ew, ew, gross,”

Despite her grimaces and gags, Adora stood there impressed. “You make it look so easy,” she said.

Catra turned back to the table, having taken a breath, now calmed enough to stare at the joint without letting out a gag. “Yeah, well, can’t keep not pitching in, right?”

Adora looked over to Catra. Her face was pensive, yet the same frustrated expression from when she stared at the pale of water

and her red stained towel remained. “You’re just doing your best,” she said, placing a hand over Catra’s. “We all are.”

“Then why are they laughing at me?” Catra asked, jerking her hand away. “Everyone else is getting on this stupid back-to-the-land bullshit and I’m the only one that’s not,”

“And that’s fine, you’re still trying to do your best,” Adora said, a hand reaching to take Catra’s shoulder but jerking back already knowing the response to the action. “Besides, you managed to get this done, right?”

“Yeah, ‘managed’,” Catra noted. “I mean, what’s even the point? No one expects me to do anything, and honestly I don’t know how much I can keep doing all of this,” she rambled, muttering bits and pieces of it to herself, but loud enough for Adora to hear. Hear the frustration, the anger, the guilt that she tried desperately to hide inside of her no matter how much she didn’t need to feel any guilt over a situation neither had any control over. Or body systems that chose the most wonderful times to clean themselves out.

That thought made Adora laugh and in some aspect understand where most of Catra’s frustrations had been coming from. Even if it had been a mildly rude understanding. Yet, she was also reminded of another thought. “Remember when Lonnie broke her arm right before we were supposed to go to Mystacore?” she asked.

Catra scoffed. “And her annoying whining about her cast being too hot,” she said, chuckling to herself at the memory.

“You told her if she shared her Percocet that we could crash Ms. Weaver’s bingo night in Plumeria,” Adora continued, the two laughing, the sound of it having become both a nice familiarity and somewhat foreign.

“I know what this is,” Catra said.

Adora raised a brow. “What is it?”

“It’s your famous pep talks,” Catra said with a teasing tone. “You’re amazing at cheering people up and not wanting to cut up a deer.”

Adora was taken aback at that, mouth opening in shock but closing quickly so as to not to risk letting a bug fly inside. Meanwhile, Catra looked at her with a cocky smile, tilting her head back in forth as if to say that she was the victor in whatever competition she chose to make in her head. “Ok, well for the record, you’re great at making people feel judged.”

“Really, after I just cut up something you couldn’t?” Catra asked.

Adora shook her head in shock, mostly due to the quick change in Catra’s demeanor. A good thing, one Adora wouldn’t dare deny, yet the fast quips she made never ceased to amaze more than just Adora. “Ok, wow,” she said. “And after I was so nice to you.”

“What can I say?” Catra teased, shrugging and laughing to herself.

Adora couldn’t hold it back for much longer, laughing once more alongside her. “But seriously, you’ve always been awesome, but out here, it’s like…” Adora studied the way Catra looked. The scratches on her knee, the rashes on her arms, the muck stuck in the knots of her always messy hair. The gleam in her heterochromic eyes that never seemed to leave. The smile on her face that changed its meaning but never its beauty. “Like you’re a total badass, you’re in your zone.” Adora finally spoke, an awkward tone jumping into her statement.

To her luck, it made Catra laugh, so whatever shame she felt washed away. “Yeah well - you kind of taught me how to be like this,” Catra said, genuinely in a way Adora rarely heard under normal circumstances. “I mean, you’re the one making people feel like they’re going to be ok just by being your dumb self.” Adora laughed at the genuine but backhanded statement. “Or at least, that’s what you did for me.”

The two girls looked at one another, smiling smiles that said more than just a simple, “Thanks,” from Adora.

Catra was the first to break eye contact, looking back down at the deer knee. “Yeah, but that’s the last thing I’m cutting up, so,”

“What? Even though you’re way better at putting a knife through a deer knee?” Adora asked.

Catra shook her head, gaze straying away from the deer knee in question. “Yeah, no, you and Arrow Boy can suck at it together,” she said. “Or maybe Entrapta could do it, I wouldn’t put it past her.”

Adora laughed, agreeing with the sentiment. She could strangely, vividly see it, too. Maybe the next time Adora needed help cutting something up, if Catra had been so determined not to do it, she could ask Entrapta to help. “Alright, deal,” Adora said. “But that doesn’t change the fact that we need you.” She looked once more at Catra. Once more into her eyes. Reached a hand out once more. “I need you, Catra.” And gained the response she quietly wanted more than anything. Catra held the hand over her shoulder, squeezing it once before letting go. She didn’t swat it, or move it away, letting the hand rest on her shoulder. “Here,” Adora moved her hand from Catra’s shoulder, going to the winged pin on her jacket to unpin it. “Good luck charm, right?” she asked, pinning the winged pin to Catra’s shirt.

“You got this from our first win,” Catra reminded, looking down at the pin.

“Yeah, but, you’re basically the best, right?” Adora asked, the two girls smiling again. “Come here,” then hugging.

Holding each other close. Pin stuck between the past and the present. Breaths sharing their relief of being able to hold each other so close. Heart beats matching each other’s pace. Hairs tickling each other’s cheeks. And bodily insides stabbing the both of them with double edged swords.

End Notes

haven't posted anything on here in a hot minute (sorry not sorry), and a yearly she-ra rewatch + watching yellowjackets = this i guess.

To whoever opened this fic and read it all the way through, thank you so much for reading! Kudos and comments would be greatly appreciated! <3

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